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Week 6 Preview

1 message

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SUMER SPORTS



Week 6 Preview

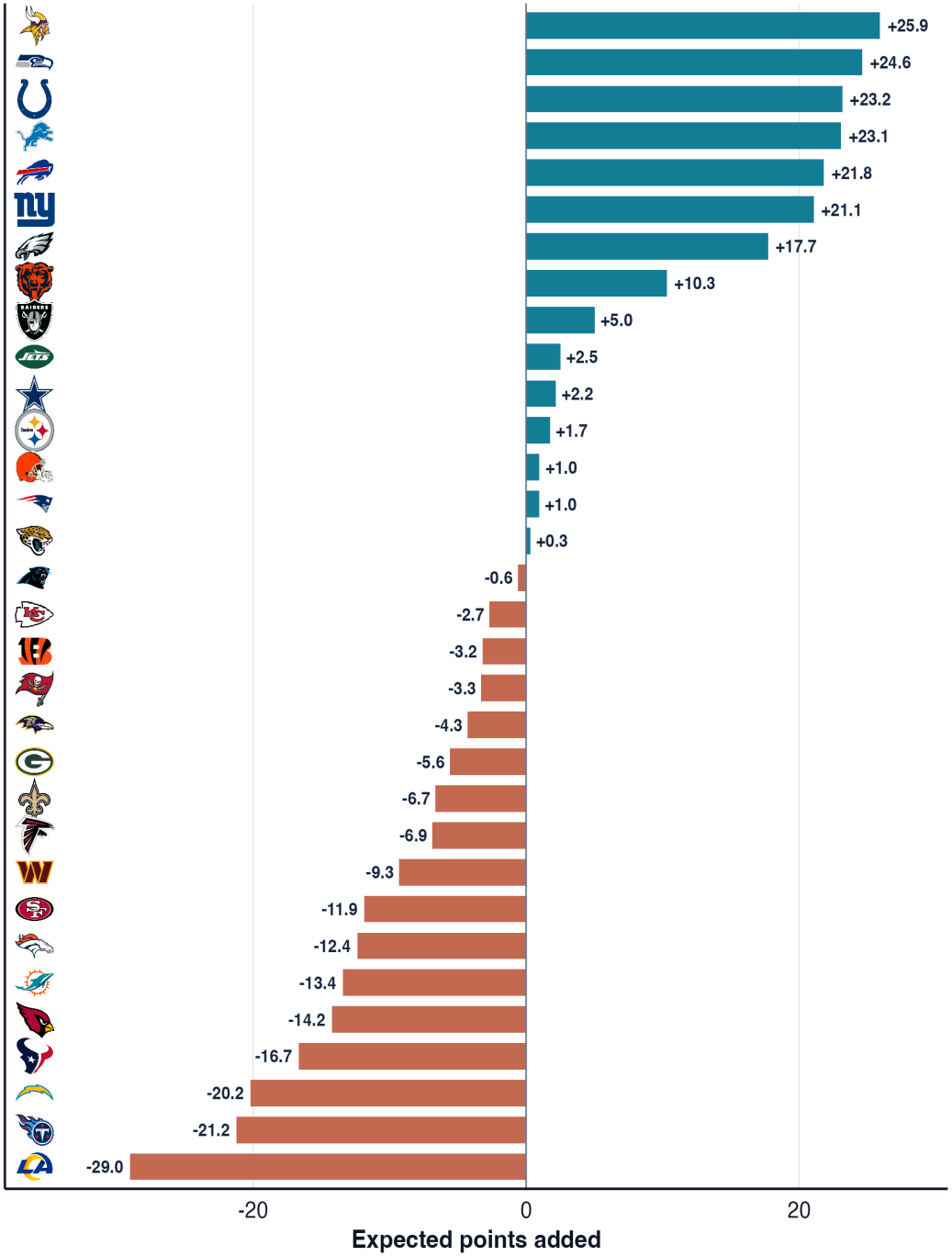
A Quick Note.

- The data you see below comes from SumerSports' SumerPass. We recommend you check it out if you want to dive deeper into the data, build your own stats, or get live charting on game days.
- Today's newsletter has some thoughts on special teams, our film favorites, and our three biggest questions of the week along with their respective preview boxes. For the rest of the game preview boxes, head over to Tej's page where they will all be posted on Thursday.

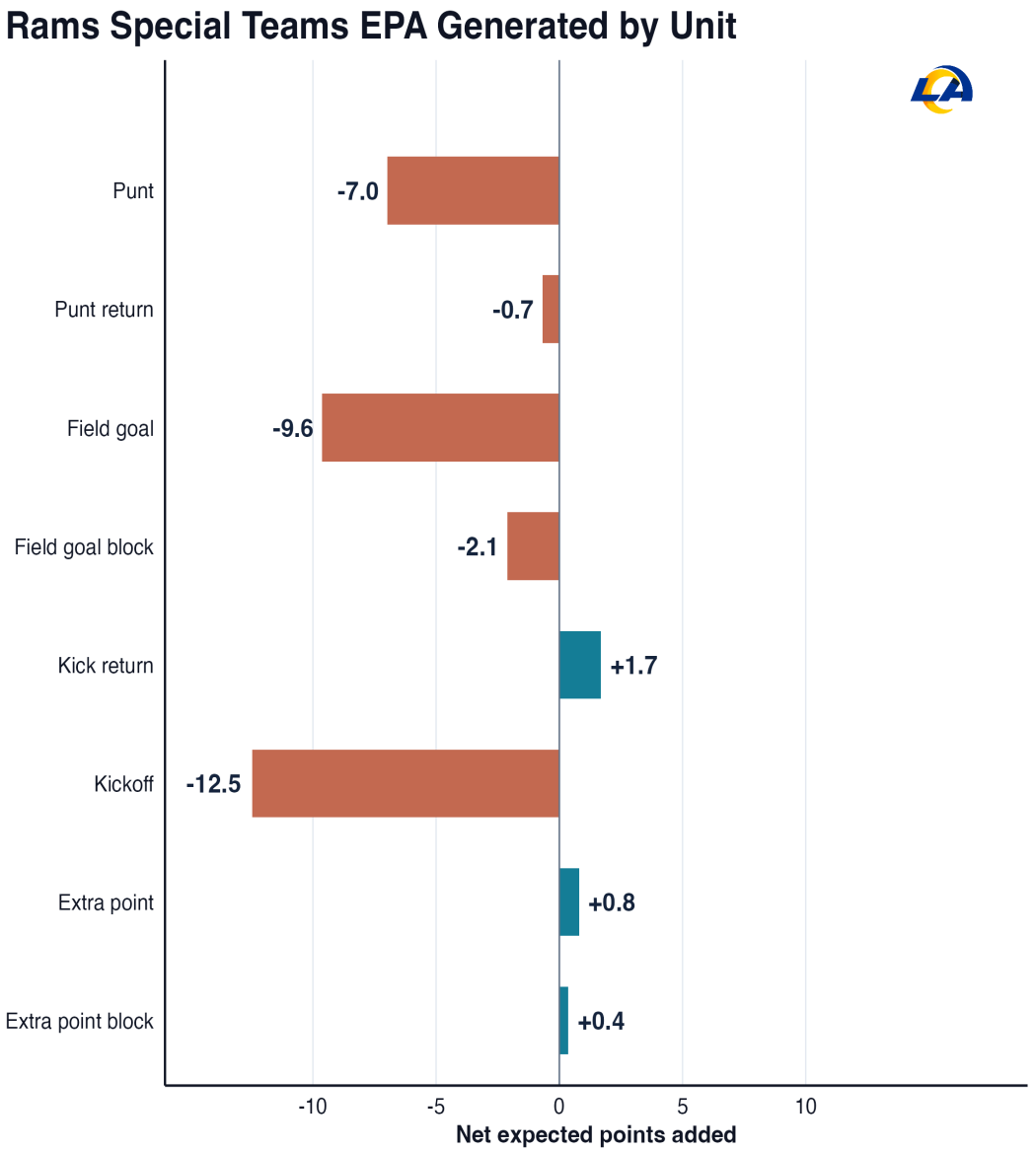
Special Teams Matter!

This is how every special teams unit has performed this season.

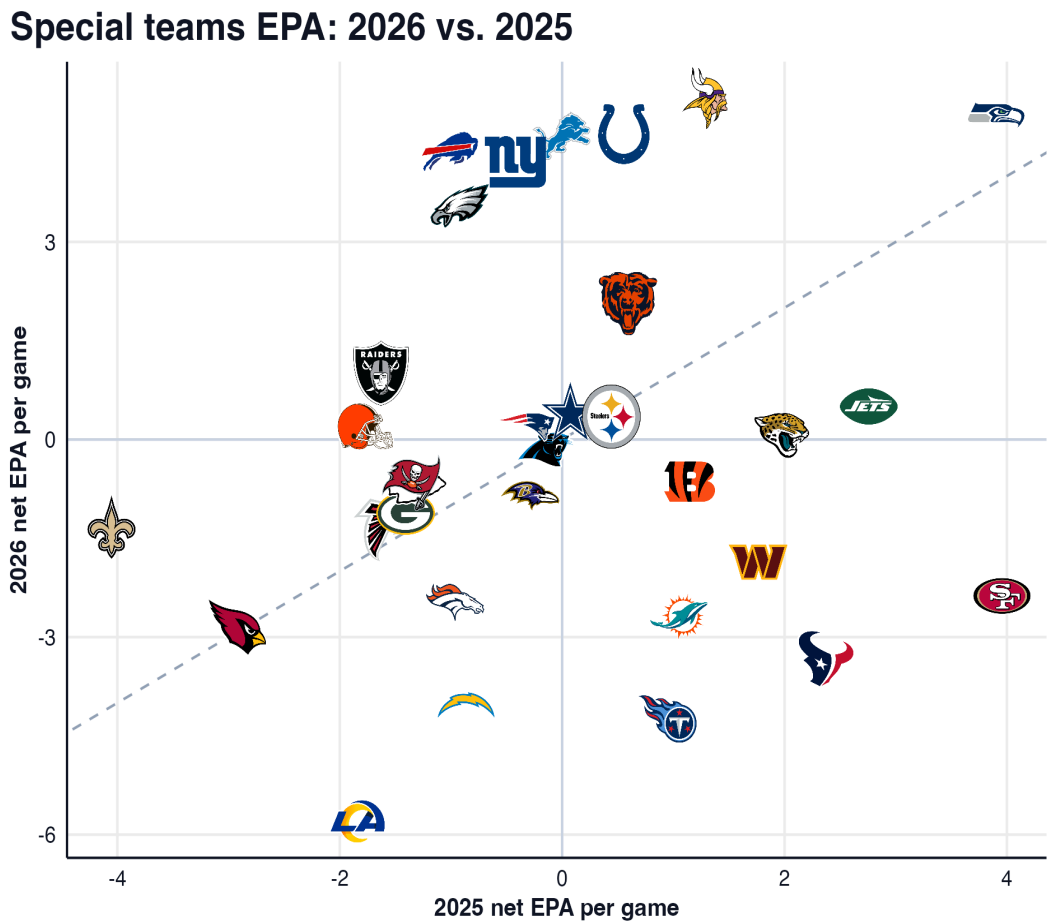
Total Team Special Teams EPA, 2026



- On the low end of the graph, we unfortunately have the Los Angeles Rams. The Rams special teams struggles were once again thrust into the spotlight as a game winning field goal was blocked on Monday night. The Rams rank worse than 20th in field goal made %, net punt average, punt return average, kickoff return average, and kickoff return allowed average.



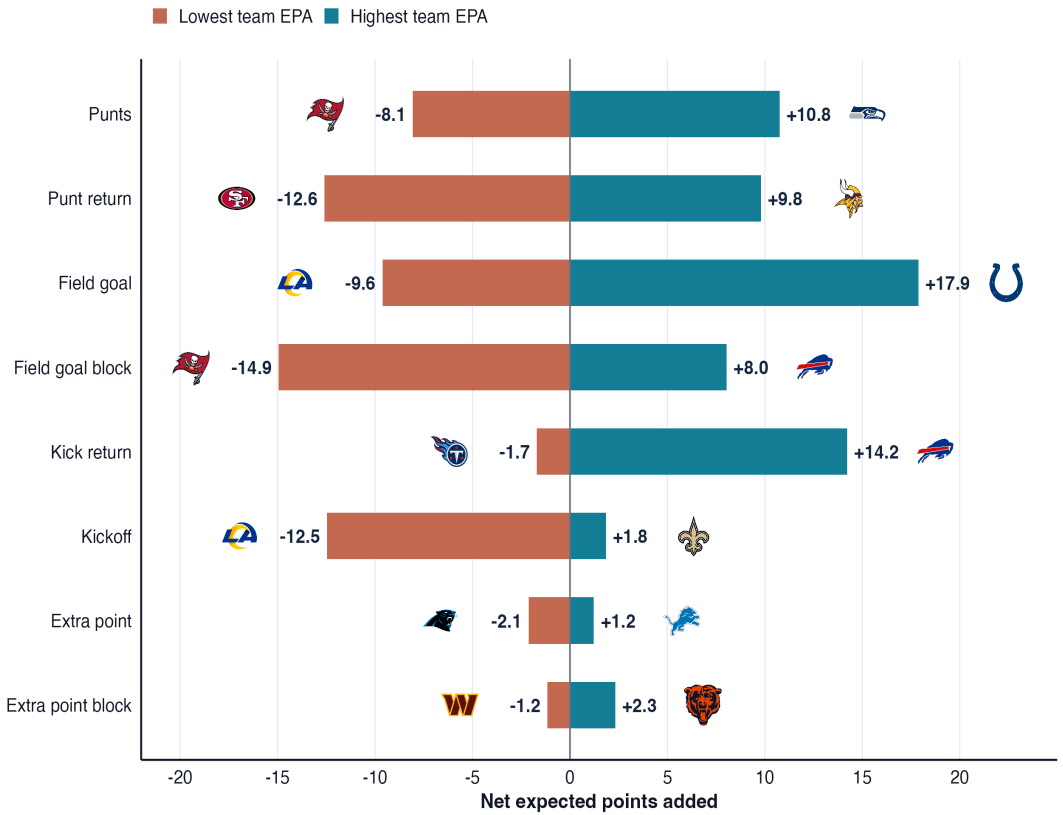
Here is a look at the league's special teams units in 2025 and 2026.



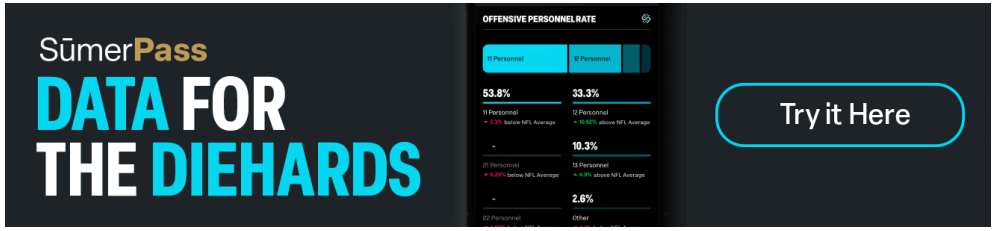
- The Seahawks are the standout on this graph with dominance in 2025 and in 2026 so far. The year-to-year correlation here is low, but Seahawks special teams coordinator Jay Harbaugh will be getting some recognition in the newsletter today. Harbaugh crossed over with Mike Macdonald at Michigan and is leading a difference making unit as Seattle continues to chase edges.

Splitting things up by each phase of special teams, here is what we have.

Special teams performance by unit



- The Vikings defense has been a great story this season, but their special teams unit also deserves a lot of credit. The Vikings currently rank in the top 10 in average punt return yards, average kick return yards, average kick return yards allowed, and field goal made %.
- Vikings returner Myles Price is the only player to rank in the top 10 in both average yards per punt return and average yards per kick return this season.



Film Favorites

Here are some interesting things from the all-22 this week with clips hyperlinked:

- A classic under center shot play.
- A devious Declan Doyle screen and a creative wildcat alignment.
- Another layer for Klint Kubiak's slice action.
- A unique way to deal with an edge defender on play action.
- More traffic in the red zone.
- A Jared Goff favorite.
- A note on a big kick return.
- Catching the defensive back attacking the bubble.
- A small tweak that led to a huge interception.
- A Trevor Lawrence middle of the field throw in slo-mo.
- Liam Coen is a speed option appreciator.
- Getting your choice route matched up against an edge rusher.

Week 6 Questions We Want Answered

Houston Texans @ Jacksonville Jaguars (London): Will the Texans defense or Jaguars offense win the battle in London?

- Liam Coen is one of our favorite play callers and is a former Stats & Scheme Offensive Coordinator of the Year (trademark application in progress). His Jaguars offense has only gone below the 25th percentile in offensive EPA/play four times. Two of those instances occurred against the Texans last season.
- The Texans defense is looking to return to its 2025 form, and DeMeco Ryans has taken back play calling. They rank 2nd in success rate but are 13th in EPA/play allowed. They also have the 5th highest pressure rate but rank 21st in EPA allowed when causing a pressure.
- Houston's defense has been vulnerable deep and over the middle of the field at times this season. The Jaguars are 3rd in middle of the field EPA/pass and the Texans are 21st in middle of the field EPA/pass allowed. The Jaguars are 7th in EPA/deep pass, and the Texans rank 26th in EPA/deep pass allowed.
- The Texans should have a big advantage with their pass rush as Danielle Hunter and Will Anderson Jr. are going up against two tackles that do not rank well in pressure rate allowed. Coen will have his hands full figuring out how to limit the Texans pass rush while still finding ways to attack down the field.

JAX Offense vs. HST Defense

Week 6 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-5 data • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
JAX Offense	0.11 (#6)	0.22 (#4)	-0.02 (#8)	46.7% (#9)	-2.2% (#24)	10.8% (#8)
HST Defense	-0.06 (#13)	-0.01 (#18)	-0.16 (#8)	38.3% (#2)	2.9% (#28)	8.7% (#12)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	13P %	13P EPA
JAX Offense	59.6% (#16)	0.10 (#9)	28.9% (#11)	0.14 (#8)	10.1% (#10)	0.14 (#10)
HST Defense	62.1% (#10)	0.02 (#26)	21.2% (#21)	-0.31 (#3)	11.3% (#8)	0.02 (#14)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
JAX Offense	50.0% (#22)	0.00 (#7)	25.9% (#15)	0.33 (#5)	45.6% (#8)	0.04 (#10)
HST Defense	55.9% (#18)	-0.19 (#8)	27.5% (#11)	-0.11 (#9)	35.0% (#23)	-0.18 (#4)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
JAX Offense	33.5% (#20)	0.10 (#9)	66.5% (#13)	0.28 (#3)	19.0% (#18)	0.69 (#3)
HST Defense	39.5% (#13)	-0.16 (#9)	60.5% (#20)	0.09 (#23)	26.0% (#28)	0.41 (#21)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
JAX Offense	31.6% (#12)	-0.04 (#17)	0.34 (#1)	36.7% (#7)	-0.36 (#17)
HST Defense	19.5% (#31)	-0.11 (#13)	0.02 (#18)	44.5% (#5)	-0.36 (#21)

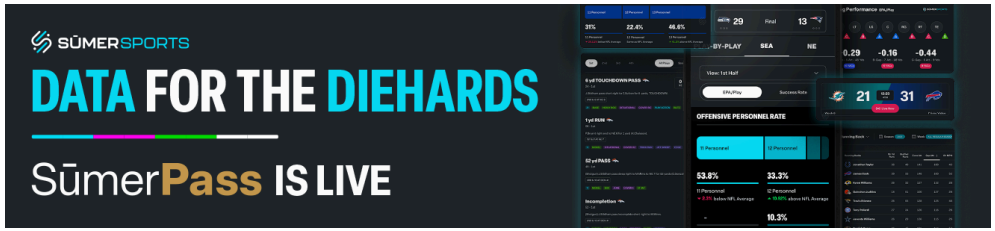
Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
JAX Offense	61.3% (#27)	0.12 (#8)	28.9% (#2)	0.73 (#5)	9.9% (#22)	0.86 (#7)
HST Defense	66.1% (#22)	-0.03 (#15)	24.3% (#8)	0.51 (#20)	9.6% (#24)	0.84 (#26)

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
JAX Offense	25.8% (#22)	0.13 (#5)	68.6% (#9)	0.12 (#7)	47.7% (#10)	0.28 (#3)
HST Defense	5.8% (#31)	0.03 (#17)	85.9% (#2)	-0.13 (#8)	50.8% (#6)	0.03 (#17)



Carolina Panthers @ Philadelphia Eagles: Will Bryce Young continue his hot start?

- Bryce Young has improved in multiple areas to start the season. Here is how Young ranked in 2025 compared to 2026 across a few metrics:
    - EPA/dropback: 30th to 9th
    - EPA on throws under 2.5 seconds: 33rd to 3rd
    - Vs. the blitz: 36th to 6th
    - Under pressure: 23rd to 5th
- One area where Young hasn't had a massive leap yet is his dropback success rate. He ranked 29th in dropback success rate last season and is 21st this year. Still, Young is on fire in 2026. Young's season is supported by Brad Idzik finding a balance between spreading things out and getting value out of condensed under center looks.
- The Eagles defense has been working through injuries and had a better day in London against the Jaguars, particularly in the first half. Teams have tried to attack the Eagles flat

players in different ways, and linebackers can find themselves in tough spots based on the structure of the defense. Bryce Young ranks first in EPA on quick out routes, and the Eagles have been vulnerable against them on the weak side of the formation.

- Jalen Carter had an absolute monster first half last week. He was a presence in the run and pass game and literally could not be blocked. Turning to this matchup, the Panthers are last in pressure rate allowed and quick pressure rate allowed. If Carter finds himself in one on one situations on the inside, he could ruin this game for Carolina.

CAR Offense vs. PHI Defense

Week 6 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-5 data • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
CAR Offense	0.08 (#8)	0.20 (#6)	-0.14 (#22)	45.5% (#12)	6.3% (#3)	11.0% (#7)
PHI Defense	0.02 (#24)	0.08 (#23)	-0.06 (#22)	45.0% (#22)	-1.4% (#11)	8.5% (#9)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	13P %	13P EPA
CAR Offense	61.7% (#11)	0.16 (#5)	29.9% (#10)	0.08 (#10)	7.6% (#14)	-0.47 (#28)
PHI Defense	69.0% (#2)	-0.01 (#21)	21.0% (#22)	0.10 (#21)	8.2% (#12)	0.20 (#22)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
CAR Offense	61.9% (#10)	-0.05 (#10)	31.1% (#5)	0.17 (#12)	34.1% (#20)	0.01 (#14)
PHI Defense	59.1% (#11)	0.04 (#29)	22.1% (#29)	0.11 (#17)	41.9% (#9)	0.04 (#22)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
CAR Offense	46.3% (#4)	0.14 (#5)	53.7% (#29)	0.25 (#8)	19.1% (#17)	0.61 (#4)
PHI Defense	15.9% (#32)	0.23 (#30)	84.1% (#1)	0.05 (#15)	26.4% (#30)	0.29 (#18)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
CAR Offense	26.6% (#25)	0.35 (#4)	0.14 (#11)	52.0% (#32)	0.00 (#2)
PHI Defense	21.5% (#28)	0.44 (#30)	-0.02 (#12)	34.9% (#29)	-0.36 (#20)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
CAR Offense	63.0% (#24)	0.08 (#13)	23.5% (#9)	0.55 (#7)	13.6% (#10)	0.84 (#8)
PHI Defense	66.9% (#21)	-0.05 (#11)	22.5% (#11)	0.69 (#25)	10.7% (#18)	-0.01 (#8)

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
CAR Offense	28.0% (#19)	0.10 (#9)	69.7% (#8)	0.13 (#5)	40.9% (#22)	0.20 (#8)
PHI Defense	17.9% (#28)	-0.09 (#12)	76.9% (#6)	0.01 (#23)	58.4% (#2)	0.09 (#24)

Chicago Bears @ Atlanta Falcons: What will the Bears offensive rebound look like?

- We are sending this before we have official word on if Caleb Williams will be back in this game, but we can still look at the offense with and without Williams in the lineup. The passing offense, perhaps unsurprisingly, took a step back without its starting quarterback in EPA/play, EPA/dropback, and scramble production. Two areas that ended up increasing a bit were success rate and middle of the field throw rate. We are hopeful that Williams will play in this game so we can get back to regularly scheduled explosive plays from Ben Johnson's Bears.
- On the other side of this matchup, we have Jeff Ulbrich's defense that has performed above expectations to start the season. The Falcons are getting after the quarterback and are 2nd in pressure rate despite ranking 25th in blitz rate. Gervon Dexter ranks 2nd in pressure rate among defensive tackles and will be facing off against his old teammates in this game.
- The Falcons defense is coming off a game where the Ravens offense was able to move the ball on them. Atlanta had allowed a 33.8% designed rushing success rate before the Ravens game, but Baltimore produced a 56.3% designed rushing success rate. Atlanta's pressure rate over the first four weeks was 48.1% but dropped to 34.2% against the Ravens.
- There are a few areas we will be focused on early in this game:
    - Atlanta ranks 32nd against middle of the field passes, and Ben Johnson loves to design concepts over the middle.
    - The Bears have the 6th highest play action rate in the league, and the Falcons rank 29th against play action passes.

- Caleb Williams has a 0.36 EPA/dropback when leaving the pocket, but his scrambling may be limited as he works back from injury.

CHI Offense vs. ATL Defense

Week 6 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-5 data • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
CHI Offense	-0.01 (#14)	0.02 (#17)	-0.04 (#12)	45.3% (#13)	-0.9% (#19)	10.3% (#11)
ATL Defense	-0.06 (#15)	-0.04 (#12)	-0.09 (#16)	42.2% (#10)	6.7% (#30)	7.5% (#4)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	13P %	13P EPA
CHI Offense	49.2% (#24)	0.10 (#8)	33.6% (#5)	-0.06 (#17)	15.8% (#5)	-0.18 (#24)
ATL Defense	67.4% (#4)	-0.07 (#9)	21.7% (#20)	0.03 (#19)	8.1% (#14)	-0.28 (#3)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
CHI Offense	70.9% (#3)	-0.10 (#14)	31.0% (#6)	0.02 (#20)	46.1% (#7)	0.01 (#13)
ATL Defense	60.0% (#9)	-0.15 (#14)	22.7% (#25)	0.32 (#29)	34.8% (#24)	-0.03 (#16)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
CHI Offense	40.6% (#9)	0.12 (#7)	59.4% (#24)	-0.05 (#20)	33.9% (#1)	0.19 (#19)
ATL Defense	37.5% (#16)	-0.06 (#14)	62.5% (#17)	-0.01 (#11)	12.9% (#2)	-0.03 (#8)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
CHI Offense	42.1% (#1)	0.12 (#10)	-0.05 (#24)	39.6% (#18)	-0.05 (#4)
ATL Defense	22.2% (#25)	-0.06 (#17)	-0.04 (#10)	45.8% (#2)	-0.34 (#22)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
CHI Offense	67.8% #15	0.03 #17	22.8% #12	0.08 #27	9.4% #24	0.30 #22
ATL Defense	69.0% #12	-0.13 #6	15.7% #32	1.01 #32	15.2% #5	-0.18 #5

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
CHI Offense	37.8% #8	-0.07 #21	54.2% #22	-0.03 #15	36.7% #28	0.12 #12
ATL Defense	20.8% #24	0.07 #20	78.6% #5	-0.09 #10	50.3% #7	-0.07 #11

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